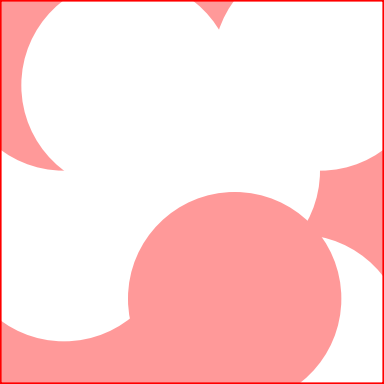
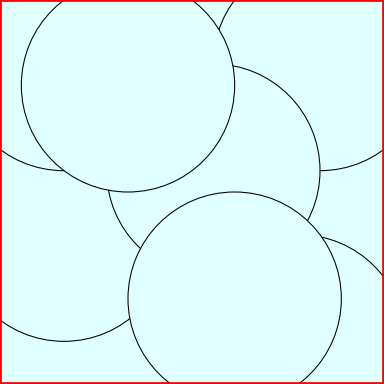
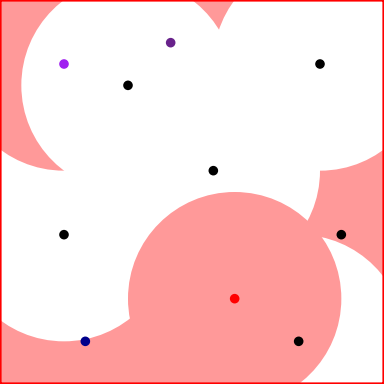








the 1990s, the number of people in the world who are undernourished has increased from 600 million to 800 million (FAO 2001). The number of people who are obese has also increased, with 1.5 billion people in the world being overweight and 300 million being obese (WHO 2000). The prevalence of obesity has increased in all countries, but the increase has been most marked in the developed countries (WHO 2000). In the United Kingdom, the prevalence of obesity has increased from 10% in 1980 to 20% in 1998 (Health Survey for England 1998). The prevalence of obesity in children has also increased, with 10% of children in the United Kingdom being obese in 1998 (Health Survey for England 1998). The increase in obesity is a major public health problem, as it is a risk factor for a number of chronic diseases, including coronary heart disease, stroke, type 2 diabetes, and certain types of cancer (WHO 2000).

The increase in obesity is a result of a number of factors, including changes in diet and lifestyle. In the developed countries, there has been a shift from a diet of high fibre, low fat foods to a diet of high fat, low fibre foods. This has been accompanied by a decrease in physical activity, as more people are working in sedentary jobs and using cars for transport. In the developing countries, there has been a shift from a diet of high fibre, low fat foods to a diet of high fat, low fibre foods. This has been accompanied by a decrease in physical activity, as more people are working in sedentary jobs and using cars for transport. The increase in obesity is a major public health problem, as it is a risk factor for a number of chronic diseases, including coronary heart disease, stroke, type 2 diabetes, and certain types of cancer (WHO 2000).

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